

If Tambu and Nyasha lives chart paths around a mountain, Lucia simply climbs it. Despite the topographical lines being so dense they nearly touch, Lucias path cuts through them. On first glance, this in part can be attributed to her naivete, she truly doesn't know (or at least pretends not to). But there is far more to it than that. Firstly Lucia can feed herself, "*Lucia had somehow managed to keep herself plump despite her tribulations*" and in doing so she is characterized as beautiful, with glowing skin. Something Nhamo only had after he spent a year at the mission. This makes it apparent that Lucia is able to feed herself as well as any man - even the rich ones.

Lucia can not only feed herself, but she can feed others. And not just vegetables but meat and milk, something reserved mostly for men. As we look at foods as means of control we see that Babamukuru and other men their ability to provide it as such, but Lucia, existing outside of this binary uses her food to help liberate her people. "*When they returned Lucia cooked the evening meal, making a thick stew out of some meat she had brought with her. 'Tambudzai,' she instructed me in my father's presence, 'make sure nobody touches this meat. Nobody besides your mother, who is ill'*". We know Tambu's mother is not ill in the literal sense, she is afflicted with the same "Nervous Conditions" that affect so many, but especially Nyasha. This contrasts with Tambu who, despite knowing that Nyasha needs her returns home with Babamukuru to continue her schooling. This is what makes Lucia such a powerful character and powerful 'map'. She exists outside of the binary's. She is somehow feminine and masculine. She is self-serving and unselfish. In a world that is an inherent contradiction, she is a contradiction unto it.